

4 Steps in the Measurement Process:

1. Conceptually defining the construct
2. Operationally defining the construct
3. Implementing the measure
4. Evaluating the measure

Conceptually Defining the Construct

Having a clear and complete conceptual definition of a construct is a prerequisite for good measurement

e.g., *"long term episodic memory" - having participants remember a list of words that they learned last week would make sense*

what does construct look like in real life, in practise

Operationally Defining the Construct

Conceptual definitions must be transformed into something that can be directly observed and measured.

e.g., *"stress" - operationally defoned as people's scores on a stress scale, cortisol concentrations in their saliva, or the number of stressful events*

Operationally Defining the Construct

Using an Existing Measure

Advantages of using an existing measure:

- Save the *time and trouble* of creating your own
- Already some evidence that the measure is valid
- Results can more easily be compared with previous results

Operationally Defining the Construct

Creating Your Own Measure

If there is no existing measure of the construct or existing ones are too difficult or time-consuming to use, may need to create your own

Some considerations when creating your own measure:

- New measures are usually *variations* of existing measures
- Strive for simplicity
- Test several people

want to make the participant responses are an accurate representation of their thoughts, feeling etc

Implementing the Measure

Want to implement a measure in a way that maximizes its reliability and validity.

participants changing their answers to appear as something they're not, to fit in,

Socially Desirable Responding: *because they are aware other people are seeing it and want to seem desirable* When participants respond in ways that they think are socially acceptable.

Demand **Characteristics:** Subtle cues that reveal to participants how the researcher expects them to respond in the experiment.

participants change their response due to subtle cues from the researcher, like if the researcher praises one participant and not the other, the one that did not get praised might change their response to get approval or the participant who was praised keeps acting that way and gives responses that are not what they would normally give just to keep being praised by the researcher

Evaluating the Measure

Evaluate your measure more thoroughly in terms of reliability and validity.

If evaluation casts doubt on the reliability or validity of your measure, it is “*back to the drawing board*”.